ONYEKA M. OBASI
onyeka.obasi@baruch.cuny.edu | onyekaobasi.com

EDUCATION

City University of New York (CUNY) Expected June 2027
The Graduate Center & Baruch College, Zicklin School of Business
Ph.D., Management and Entrepreneurship

> ***Dissertation:*** Essays on Platform Governance, Coordination, and Firm Boundaries.
> ***Committee:*** Elena Vidal-Branciforte (Chair), Konstantina Ploumi, Helaine Korn, Karl Lang, Tobias Kretschmer.

Massachusetts Institute of Technology, Sloan School of Management 2016
Master of Business Administration, MBA

Harvard University, John F. Kennedy School of Government 2012
Master of Public Administration

Boston University School of Public Health
Master of Public Health, MPH

University of Nigeria, Nsukka, Nigeria
Bachelor of Science (BSc.) in Zoology (Human Parasitology)

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Strategy | Platforms & Ecosystems | Firm Boundaries & Governance | Organizational Design | Industry Evolution | AI & Competition

WORK IN PROGRESS

Working Papers:

Obasi, O.M. Persistent Coordination Strain and Ownership-Based Sourcing in Platform Ecosystems: Evidence from U.S. SVOD Services: *Preparing Submission*; Target: *Organization Science.*

Selected for presentation in the 2026 INFORMS Annual Meeting Job Market Showcase Track.

Previously circulated as "When Coordination Breaks Down: Platform Disequilibrium and Selective Vertical Integration in Platform Ecosystems."

Obasi, O.M., & Rawley, E. Governance by Design: Enabling Contractibility Through Digital Architecture. Stage: *Preparing Submission*; Target: *Strategic Management Journal.*

Manuscript nominated for PhD Student Paper Prize – SMS 2026.

Previously circulated as "Coordination and Control without Ownership: A Theory of Governance by Design."

Obasi, O.M., & Kyprianou, C. Platform Governance in Complex Ecosystems: A Systematic Review and Research Agenda. Stage: *Drafting*; Target: *Journal of Management*

Obasi, O.M. Organizing Under Dual Constraints in Entrepreneurial Ecosystems: Evidence from Public Funding Programs. Stage*: Data Analysis*

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Obasi, O.M., & Rawley, E. (December 2026). **Governance by Design: Enabling Contractibility Through Digital Architecture.** 2026 Corporate Strategy and Innovation Conference, The Wharton School, University of Pennsylvania. December 3–4, 2026. Philadelphia, PA, USA. Accepted for Poster Presentation.

Obasi, O.M. (November 2026). **Persistent Coordination Strain and Ownership-Based Sourcing in Platform Ecosystems: Evidence from U.S. SVOD Services.** Tepper School Colloquium on Artificial Intelligence for Business, Carnegie Mellon University. November 12–14, 2026. Pittsburgh, PA, USA. Accepted for Presentation.

Obasi, O.M. (November 2026). **When Coordination Breaks Down: Platform Disequilibrium and Selective Vertical Integration in Platform Ecosystems.** 2026 INFORMS Annual Meeting, Job Market Showcase Track. November 1–4, 2026. San Francisco, CA, USA.

Obasi, O.M., & Rawley, E. (October 2026). **Coordination and Control without Ownership: A Theory of Governance by Design.** 46th Annual Conference of the Strategic Management Society. October 17 – 20, 2026. Berlin, Germany. **Nominated for PhD Paper Prize.**

Obasi, O.M., & Rawley, E. (August 2026). **Coordination and Control without Ownership: A Theory of Governance by Design.** 86th Annual Meeting of the Academy of Management. July 31 – August 4, 2026. Philadelphia, PA, USA

Obasi, O.M. (July 2026). **Organizing Under Dual Constraints in Entrepreneurial Ecosystems: Evidence from Public Funding Programs.** 42nd European Group for Organizational Studies Colloquium. July 9 – 11, 2026. Bergamo, Italy. (Online)

Obasi, O.M. (April 2025). **Organizing Under Dual Constraints: Boundary Decisions in Hybrid-Founded, Publicly Funded Ventures in Latin America.** 7th Annual Baruch College Research Symposium. April 24 – 25, 2025. Baruch College, NYC.

Obasi, O.M. (October 2024). **From Fragmentation to Efficiency: The Coasian Logic of Super Apps**. The 44th Annual Conference of the Strategic Management Society, October 19 – 22, 2024. Istanbul, Turkey.

Obasi, O.M. (April 2024). **Apps on Steroids: Evidence in Super App Adoption by Digital Platform Firms and Institutional Voids.** East Coast Doctoral Conference, April 26, 2024. Columbia University Business School, New York**.**

Obasi, O.M. (April 2024). **Platform Firm Vertical Integration into complementor's space in a multi-sided market: Evidence from the streaming service market**. 6th Annual Baruch College Research Symposium, April 18 – 19, 2024. Baruch College, NYC.

WORKSHOPS & DOCTORAL CONSORTIA

2026 The 86th Annual Meeting of the Academy of Management, TIM Doctoral Consortium. August 1, 2026. Philadelphia, Pennsylvania.

2026 The 42nd European Group for Organizational Studies, Doctoral Workshop. July 9 – 11, 2026. Bergamo, Italy. (Online)

2026 The Consortium on Competitiveness and Cooperation (CCC) Conference for Doctoral Students, June 4 – 6, 2026. Bocconi University, Milan, Italy

2025 The 45th Annual Conference of the Strategic Management Society, October 11 – 14, 2025. Doctoral Workshop. San Francisco.

2025 The 85th Annual Meeting of the Academy of Management, STR Division Doctoral Consortium. July 25 – 29, 2025. Copenhagen, Denmark

2025 The 85th Annual Meeting of the Academy of Management, STR Managing Your Dissertation Workshop. July 25 – 29, 2025 Copenhagen, Denmark
2025 The 85th Annual Meeting of the Academy of Management, Organization Science Paper Development Workshop. July 25 – 29, 2025. Copenhagen, Denmark
2025 Workshop on Strategies for Teaching Success in the Classroom. June 23 – 25, 2025. Bentley University, Massachusetts.
2025 The 2025 INFORMS Strategy Science Doctoral Workshop, June 12 – 14, 2025. IESE Business School. Barcelona, Spain
2025 Providence College Business Case Writing Workshop, May 20 – 22, 2025. Providence College, Rhode Island.
2024 The 84th Annual Meeting of the Academy of Management, TIM Doctoral Research Development Workshop, August 9 – 13, 2024. Chicago, Illinois.

FELLOWSHIPS, SCHOLARSHIPS, TRAVEL GRANTS

2025 Baruch College Travel Grant, Strategic Management Society Conference, San Francisco, CA, USA. *($2,245.19)*
2025 The AoM STR Division Travel Award - Academy of Management Conference, Copenhagen, Denmark. *($600)*
2025 Baruch College Travel Grant, INFORMS Strategy Science Conference, Barcelona, Spain**.** *($2,173.69)*
2024 Baruch College Travel Grant – Strategic Management Society Conference, Istanbul, Turkey. *($2,993.14)*
2016 Forte Foundation Fellowship Award for Women MBAs *($15,000)*
2016 MIT Sloan School of Management Dean's Fellowship *($15,000)*
2011 Harvard University, John F. Kennedy School of Government, Academic Scholarship *($60,000)*

ACADEMIC RESEARCH GRANTS

2026 PhD Program in Business Research Grant, Zicklin School of Business, Baruch College *($4,000)*
2026 Zicklin School of Business Research Grant, Baruch College. *($3,099.15)*
2026 Jean Boddewyn International Business Research Grant, Zicklin School of Business, Baruch College *($2,500)*
2026 Round 21 Doctoral Student Research Grant, City University of New York Graduate Center. *($1400)*
2025 Banerjee Babu Research Grant (BBRG). The Graduate Center, City University of New York *($1,400)*
2024 Round 19 Doctoral Student Research Grant, City University of New York Graduate Center. ($850)

AWARDS & DISTINCTIONS

2026 Best Reviewer Award, Corporate Strategy Interest Group (CSIG), Strategic Management Society.

2026 Strategic Management Society Annual Conference PhD Paper Prize Nominee.

2025 – 2026 Zicklin School of Business, Dean's Teaching Award.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Zicklin School of Business, Baruch College, CUNY
Fundamentals of Management, MGT 3120 (Core Course)

Spring 2026: Instructor Evaluation, 4.8/5
Fall 2025: Instructor Evaluation, 4.8/5
Spring 2025: Instructor Evaluation, 4.5/5
Fall 2024: Instructor Evaluation, 4.5/5

TEACHING INTERESTS: Strategic Management, Platforms and Ecosystems, AI and Innovation.

ACADEMIC SERVICE

2026 Discussant, the 42nd EGOS Colloquium. Sub-theme 46: Reframing Inter-Organizational Relations in the World of the Fourth Industrial Revolution: From Technological Partnerships to Digital Ecosystems.
2026 Discussant, 8th Annual Baruch College Research Symposium, NYC.
2026 Reviewer, STR & TIM Division – The 86th Annual Meeting of the Academy of Management Conference, Philadelphia, PA
2026 Reviewer, The 46th Annual Conference of the Strategic Management Society. Berlin, Germany **- Recipient, Best Reviewer Award, CSIG.**
2025 Reviewer, The 45th Annual Conference of the Strategic Management Society. San Francisco, CA
2023 Chair, Management Division Panel Session at the 5th Annual Baruch College Research Symposium, NYC.

RESEARCH SOFTWARE

Stata, SPSS, R, Python, LaTeX, Qualtrics

SELECTED INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

2021 – 2022 **Co-Founder & COO, Spetra Inc., New York, NY.**
Co-founded and led strategy for a fintech startup building contactless payment technology.

2019 – 2021 **VP of Marketing & Development, Community Development Long Island, NY.**
Managed a $20M+ grant portfolio and grew the donor base 78% through a digital transformation strategy.

2018 – 2019 **CMO, Alchemy Finance Inc., New York, NY.**
Built B2B marketing strategy and customer acquisition campaigns for a peer-to-peer lending platform.

2013 – 2019 **Co-Founder & CEO, Hemisphere Frontiers Consulting LLC, New York, NY.**
Negotiated multi-million-dollar energy and infrastructure deals across Africa, Middle East, and East Asia.

2005 – 2018 **Founder & President, Friends of Africa International Inc. (FAI), New York, NY.**
Led development projects across 20+ countries. Contributed to advocacy and stakeholder engagement supporting the World Bank's IDA16 replenishment effort, which raised $49.3 billion.

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

Academy of Management
Strategic Management Society
INFORMS

OTHER

Citizenship: USA

LIST OF REFERENCES

Elena Vidal Branciforte, PhD
Associate Professor in Strategic Management
Coordinator of the Ph.D. Program in Management & Entrepreneurship
Narendra P. Loomba Department of Management
Zicklin School of Business
Baruch College | CUNY
E: Elena.Vidal@baruch.cuny.edu
Relationship: Chair, Dissertation Committee

Tobias Kretschmer, PhD
Professor of Strategy, Technology and Organization
Department of Management and Entrepreneurship
Imperial College Business School
E: t.kretschmer@imperial.ac.uk
Relationship: Mentor & Member of Dissertation Committee.

Evan Rawley, PhD
Eversource Energy Scholar in Technological Entrepreneurship
Professor, Management & Entrepreneurship
Management Department
University of Connecticut School of Business
E: evan.rawley@uconn.edu
Relationship: Mentor & Co-author

Brian Silverman, PhD
Professor, Strategic Management
J.Robert S. Prichard and Ann Wilson Chair in Management
Rotman School of Management
University of Toronto, Canada
E: silverman@rotman.utoronto.ca
Relationship: Mentor